BRIGHT C. SIKAZWE

AI Product Manager | AI Use-Case Strategy · Business Value · Adoption · Africa Business Operations

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CERTIFIED: **AWS Certified AI Business Strategist · Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer** · Microsoft Azure Data Engineer Associate · Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst · Anthropic AI Fluency, Claude API & Agent Skills · Google Responsible AI · McKinsey Product Academy

PROFILE

AI product and data leader who has spent eleven years inside the CANAL+ Group's African business at MultiChoice, working at exactly the interface this role sits on: between business teams who own the problem and the engineers who build the solution. I find where AI can remove friction in end-to-end processes, qualify and prioritise use cases by value, feasibility, data readiness and risk, define success KPIs and data sources before build, decide make-or-buy, and then measure whether people actually use what was delivered. I know the subscription business from the inside — payments and their allocation, suspensions and reconnections, entitlements, packages and the contact centre — across 46 African markets, and I have worked directly with CANAL+ teams on shared programmes. AWS Certified AI Business Strategist, which validates AI use-case selection, business cases, responsible-AI governance and scaling from pilot to production; and Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer, so I can take use cases from idea to production on Google Cloud — BigQuery, Vertex AI and Gemini — as well as AWS and Microsoft. Master of Management in Digital Business (Wits); PhD candidate (University of Johannesburg) in ethical and responsible AI for strategic decision-making.

FIT TO THE ROLE

- **Use-case identification & scoping —** analyse end-to-end processes, qualify AI opportunities, write solution briefs and scope, and co-validate KPIs and data sources with the business before any build starts.
- **Prioritisation —** use-case portfolios ranked by business value, strategic fit, feasibility, data readiness, risk and time to value.
- **Make-or-buy & market intelligence —** evaluated cloud AI platforms and models (Google Cloud Vertex AI and Gemini, AWS Bedrock, Microsoft Fabric, Claude) on cost, fit and lock-in; built a make-or-buy decision tool (MOSAIC).
- **Ecosystem collaboration —** partnered with platform, engineering, marketing-automation, BI and leadership teams; challenged design choices on cost and governance grounds.
- **Adoption & value tracking —** post-launch usage and adoption measured against baselines; executive dashboards that leaders use daily; corrective actions when uptake stalls.
- **Change enablement —** translate AI capabilities and limits into plain language for non-technical leaders; former university lecturer in computing and AI; mentor analysts and engineers.
- **Responsible AI —** personal data masked before any model call, human review for low-confidence cases, audit trails; doctoral research on responsible AI in strategic decisions.
- **Africa financial processes & operations —** payments, suspensions, reconnections, entitlements and contact-centre operations at MultiChoice; regulated finance at Standard Bank.

AI USE CASES TAKEN FROM BUSINESS NEED TO ADOPTION — CANAL+ GROUP (MULTICHOICE)

Technical Calls Intelligence — from 140,798 customer calls to a prioritised intervention portfolio (live)

- **Business need:** Operations could count customer calls but not explain them: no view of why customers called, which business decision failed, or which contacts were preventable.
- **Scoping:** Mapped every call to enterprise outcomes, 12 customer value streams, the failed business decision and the accountable owner — including financial processes such as payment allocation, financial suspension versus technical reauthorisation, and reconnection.
- **Prioritisation & KPIs:** Interventions ranked by value, strategic fit, feasibility, data readiness, risk and time to value; KPIs agreed upfront for avoidable demand, digital deflection, automation potential, repeat contact, and revenue and retention risk.
- **Make-or-buy:** Compared Microsoft Fabric with AWS, and low-cost against stronger AI models; chose cheap models for routine calls and stronger models or people only for exceptions. Proved value on Fabric, now live on AWS.

EPL viewer cohorts for marketing activation — joint programme with CANAL+

- **Outcome:** Classified 489,425 connected smartcards into four campaign-ready cohorts — Retain, Win-Back, Upsell and Awareness — identifying 298,772 activatable customers fed into marketing-automation platforms for personalised offers.
- **Alignment:** Resolved an 8× gap against a CANAL+ benchmark by aligning definitions with the Paris team; the method became a joint standard. Passed three independent validation tests before marketing used it.

Fleet upgrade programme (FSU/CCA) — data lead, CANAL+ and MultiChoice

- **Adoption monitoring:** Built the daily executive view for a 14-million-device, 46-country software rollout; tracked adoption on trial groups (28% → 55%+ in six days) and flagged blockers early.
- **Value:** Root-cause analysis isolated a fault affecting ~1.6M devices and guided a fix for ~1.4M; a security-integrity exposure fell from 52% to under 1% of devices.

AI in operations

- **Delivered:** A five-agent incident-triage pipeline in production with human escalation; AI classification of support conversations by decoder error code, separating network faults from billing blockers so each reaches the right team.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MultiChoice Group (a CANAL+ company) | Johannesburg *Jan 2014 – Present*

Acting Principal Engineer & Lead, Data Platforms & Engineering *2025 – Present*

- Lead data and AI use cases from business need to adoption for a ~20M-subscriber, 46-market business; formal team lead; daily engagement with senior VP leadership and CANAL+ counterparts.

Senior Engineer: Infield Insights (Engineering Analytical) *2019 – 2025*

- Owned device and subscriber analytics; delivered the EPL cohort programme with CANAL+ and the AI incident-triage pipeline; wrote the delivery and governance standard used across AI work.

Senior Analytics Lead, Group Analytics (2015–2019) · Senior Data Analyst (2014–2015) *2014 – 2019*

- Group-wide subscriber, sales and marketing analytics; business-process and KPI design for commercial teams.

brytesika-AI (applied-AI practice) | Founder *2025 – Present*

- Applied-AI products for African markets, including ChickenIQ (live poultry-health app for smallholder farmers) and MOSAIC, a make-or-buy-or-integrate decision tool.

UTi Worldwide | BI Operations Lead *2012 – 2014*

- Operational reporting and process analytics across global supply-chain systems.

Standard Bank Group | Business Intelligence Consultant *2011 – 2012*

- Financial reporting and data integration in a regulated banking environment.

Monash University | Junior Lecturer *2009 – 2010*

- Taught and mentored students in computing and AI.

FORMAL EDUCATION

- PhD candidate — University of Johannesburg. Research: ethical and responsible AI for strategic decision-making.
- Master of Management (MMgt), Digital Business — Wits Business School.
- BSc Honours, Computing — Monash • BSc Computer Science — Copperbelt University.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- **AI strategy:** AWS Certified AI Business Strategist (AIB-C01), October 2026 — identifying and prioritising AI use cases, building business cases, responsible-AI governance, and scaling adoption from pilot to production.
- **Product & AI fluency:** McKinsey Product Academy; Pendo product-management certifications; Anthropic AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations; Google Responsible AI series (Fairness & Bias; Interpretability & Transparency; Privacy & Safety).
- **Google Cloud:** Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer (September 2026) — designing, building and operating data and ML systems on Google Cloud: BigQuery, Dataflow, Vertex AI pipelines and governed data for Gemini-based AI; plus the Google Cloud AI-agent series and Google Responsible AI.
- **Data & cloud:** Microsoft Azure Data Engineer Associate; Fabric Analytics Engineer; Power BI Data Analyst; Oracle Generative AI Professional; Anthropic — Claude API, Agent Skills.
- **In progress:** Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect; AWS Data Engineer Associate; AWS Generative AI Developer Professional.

TOOLS & METHODS

- Process mapping and value-stream analysis; use-case scoring and prioritisation; KPI design and benefits tracking; make-or-buy analysis; agile delivery; Power BI and executive dashboards; SQL and Python for evidence; AI and data platforms — Google Cloud (BigQuery, Vertex AI, Gemini), AWS Bedrock, Microsoft Fabric, Databricks, Claude.